Studio Report: The ArMiDillo

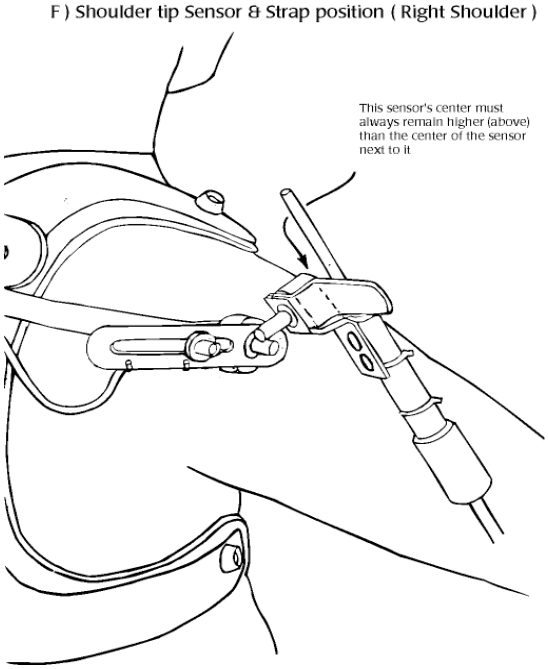
Exo-sensory body instruments

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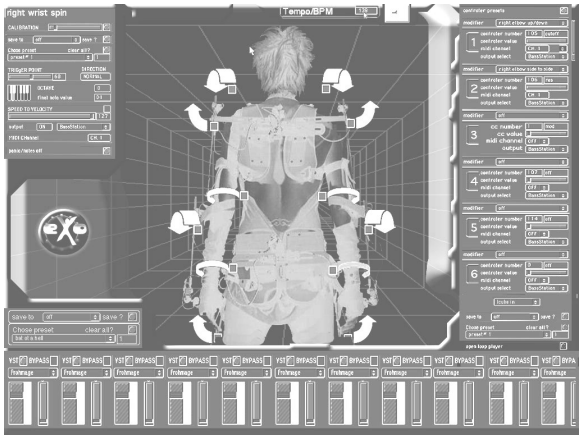
At the close of 2001, I was fortunate enough to spend a couple of months in San Francisco working on a research project. During my time there, I met and worked with Bruce Tupling (Vaporvent Studios) and Nir Bakshy from Animazoo, who were developing a MIDI-suit. The suit is now in production, and I am about to embark on another research trip to workshop the new suit and write the manual for the software.

Animazoo have sent me a demo version of the suit to work with prior to my visit, by which time the new model ArMiDillo will be released.



Exosense is based is San Francisco,CA and Brighton, UK.
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"With Exosense movements are music. DJs and producers find a lot of interesting ways to make electronic music performances seem live and interactive, but it is rarely exciting to watch.

Now artists have the advantage of the Exosense, an exo-sensory body instrument, that allows music authoring in real time performance. The Exosense suit translates body movements into sounds, loops, lights and visuals, Completely merging performers and their art. .
Exosense is both visually pleasing and technologically advanced, bringing a futuristic and professional polish to any live performance

Remarkably light and comfortable Exosense suit is modelled on the human skeletal form, using rotational sensors placed on the body joints. The suit simply plugs into a midi interface and body movements send midi signals directly to sound modules and to popular audio sequencing software such as, Logic Audio, Cubase, Live and Reason.

Software included with Exosense enables users to control midi notes, continuous controllers(e.g. cutoff and resonance), pitch bend as well as play scales, trigger loops, samples and visuals. The software is designed with versatility in mind and allows musicians and developers to continue to expand the many possible applications of their Exosense.

Development originally started with the Environment of Emagic Logic™.
A complete working system was created with this robust sequencer and this in some ways provided the ideal 'breadboard' for the functional aspects of the suit and musical performance.

Current development of the latest version of the suit software far exceeds the previous prototypes and the latest build provides a complete solution for the exosense midi system. Using more powerful audio construction software the user definability and suit control has taken on new levels of precision."

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